

Alexander Porto

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EDUCATION

Duquesne University (Dept. Psychology) Ph.D. Clinical Psychology Pittsburgh, PA, USA	2022–present
Duquesne University (Dept. Psychology) M.A. Clinical Psychology Pittsburgh, PA, USA	2022–2023
Universität Leipzig M.Sc. Early Childhood Research (Focus: Developmental Psychology & Cognitive Anthropology) Thesis: <i>A Critical Theory of Childhood Research</i> Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Kristina Musholt, Prof. Dr. Patricia Kanngießer Leipzig, Germany	2018–2020
Point Park University B.A. Psychology Thesis: <i>Phenomenological Responses to Architectural Environments</i> Pittsburgh, PA, USA	2011–2015

ACADEMIC POSITIONS & EMPLOYMENT

Universität Potsdam (Dept. Philosophy) <i>Visiting Researcher</i> Project: Nodal Logic: Epistemology, Logic, and Argument Mapping	2025–present
Universität Leipzig <i>Predoctoral Research Fellow</i> Project: The Production of Symbolic Communication During Language Acquisition	2021–2022
Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology (Dept. Comparative Cultural Psychology) <i>Guest Researcher</i> Project: The Production of Symbolic Communication During Language Acquisition	2021–2022
Universität Leipzig <i>Graduate Research Assistant</i> Project: Emotions & Social Cognition Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Robert Hepach	2019–2020
Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology (Dept. Comparative Cultural Psychology) <i>Research Internship</i> Project: Social Learning in Austronesian Cultures Supervisors: Dr. Roman Stengelin, Dr. Sarah Peoples	2019–2020

TEACHING

Research Methods in Psychology <i>Duquesne University (Dept. Psychology)</i> Description: Developed syllabus; delivered lectures; administered exams; graded coursework; provided undergraduate research mentorship.	Fall 2024, Fall 2025, Spring 2026
Statistics for the Psychological Sciences <i>Duquesne University (Dept. Psychology)</i> Description: Designed new course for the department using R programming and open-source textbooks to create an undergraduate-appropriate intro to statistical programming for psychology; developed syllabus; delivered lectures; administered and graded portfolio exams.	Spring 2025
Introduction to Psychology <i>Duquesne University (Dept. Psychology)</i> Description: Developed syllabus; delivered lectures; administered exams; graded coursework.	Fall 2023, Spring 2024

Psychological Disorders (Teaching Assistant)

Spring 2023

Duquesne University (Dept. Psychology)

Supervisor: Russ Walsh, Ph.D.

Description: Graded coursework and exams.

Laboratory in Psychology (Teaching Assistant)

Fall 2022

Duquesne University (Dept. Psychology)

Supervisor: Alex Kranjec, Ph.D.

Description: Provided undergraduate research mentorship; graded coursework.

PSYCHOTHERAPY & COMMUNITY PSYCHOLOGY

Practicum Trainee

Aug. 2025–April 2026

Carnegie Mellon University, Counseling and Psychological Services (CaPS)

Pittsburgh, PA

Clinical Supervisors: Stella Yan, Ph.D., Shane Chaplin, Ph.D., Grace Wei, Ph.D., NCC

Practicum Trainee

Jan. 2022–April 2026

Duquesne University, Rita M. McGinley Psychology Clinic

Pittsburgh, PA

Clinical Supervisors: Kevin Smith, Ph.D., Liz Pienkos, Ph.D., Lori Koelsch, Ph.D., Jessie Goicoechea, Ph.D.

Community-Based Psychology Fellow

2022–2023

Duquesne University

Pittsburgh, PA

PUBLICATIONS

Porto, A., Huckle, N., Basalyga, A., Santiago, J., Kranjec., A. (2025). Glyph Norming: Human and Computational Measurements of Shape Angularity in Writing Systems. *Behavior Research Methods*. <https://doi.org/10.3758/s13428-025-02682-7>

Porto, A., Basalyga, A., Huckle, N., Santiago, J., Fein, E., Kranjec., A. (2024). Sound Symbolism Across Diverse Writing Systems. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*. <https://escholarship.org/uc/item/3xc6659p>.

Brar, P., Pienkos, L., **Porto, A.**, Wood, H., Sarpal, D., Schreiber, J., Kalarchian, M., Kranjec, A. (2024). Methods and Models for Investigating Anomalous Experiences in Schizophrenia Spectrum Disorders. *Philosophical Psychology*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/09515089.2024.2305232>.

Contributions: Wrote section on network modeling; general consulting on manuscript development

Porto, A. (under review: revisions submitted; draft available by request). Probabilistic claiming as meta-comparative practice.

Porto, A. (under review: revisions submitted; draft available by request). Inference, Language, Situated Conceptualization.

Porto, A. (under review; draft available by request). Naturalizing Negation.

Porto, A. (2023). A Picture Theory of Symbolic Development in Early Childhood. *Theory & Psychology*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/09593543231192973>

Porto, A., Anderson, L., Kalinich, T., Deane, K. C., Vogel, L. C., Zebracki, K. (2019). Understanding transition for youth with spinal cord injury: Youth and caregiver perceptions. *The Journal of Spinal Cord Medicine*, 1-7. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10790268.2019.1574437>

PUBLICATIONS IN PREPARATION

Porto, A., Huckle, N., Basalyga, A., Cuskley, C., Perlman, M., Kranjec., A. (in preparation). Sound-Form Iconicity in Spontaneously Produced Drawings.

Status: Data collected; data analyzed; manuscript in development; abstract and data available by request.

Porto, A., Pietschmann, J., Seiberth, L.C. (in preparation). Experimental Reanimation: Jumblese, Picturing, and Representational Systems.

Status: Data collected; data analyzed; manuscript written; three workshop presentations given; in informal peer review; abstract and data available by request.

Porto, A., Pietschmann, J., Seiberth, L.C. (in preparation). *Jumblese, Picturing, and Representational Systems*. Status: Philosophical scoping review complete; manuscript written; two colloquium presentations; in informal peer review; abstract available by request.

CONFERENCE, WORKSHOP & COLLOQUIUM PRESENTATIONS

(†) *invited*

(*) *refereed*

Porto, A. (2025, October). *Interlocutor: Rules, Functions & Categories—A Workshop on Wilfrid Sellars*[†] [Invited Respondent]. Universität Paderborn.

Porto, A., Pietschmann, J., Seiberth, L. C. (2025, April). *Jumblese, picturing, and representational systems*[†] [Invited presentation]. CO Haag—Universität Potsdam.

Porto, A., Tilak, S., Pangaro, P., Glassman, M. (2025, August). *A lexical analysis of essays written using the ThoughtShuffler and Google search interfaces** [Conference presentation]. American Psychological Association Annual Convention.

Porto, A. (2025, January). *Naturalizing negation*[†] [Invited conference presentation]. Wittgenstein & the Formal Sciences IV, UNESCO World Logic Day.

Porto, A. (2024, December). *Naturalizing negation: Responding to the threefold puzzle of negation* [Colloquium]. Young Network for Wittgensteinian Philosophy.

Porto, A. (2024, July). *Sound symbolism across diverse writing systems** [Conference presentation]. 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society.

Porto, A. (2024, June). *Sound symbolism across diverse writing systems** [Conference presentation]. IMPRS 4th Conference on Interdisciplinary Approaches to the Language Sciences, International Max Planck School for Language Sciences.

Porto, A. (2024, May). *Sound symbolism across diverse writing systems** [Conference presentation accepted]. The Developing Communicators Conference 2024, University of Oslo.

Porto, A. (2024, May). *Sound symbolism across diverse writing systems** [Conference presentation accepted]. 15th Dubrovnik Conference on Cognitive Science: Memory, Space, Language, Center for Advanced Studies of Dubrovnik, Croatia.

Porto, A. (2024, May). *The picture theory of symbolic development in early childhood** [Conference presentation accepted]. 15th Dubrovnik Conference on Cognitive Science: Memory, Space, Language, Center for Advanced Studies of Dubrovnik, Croatia.

Porto, A. (2024, May). *Positive and negative predication: Distinction through unity** [Conference presentation]. Joint Meeting of the Interdisciplinary Coalition for North American Phenomenologists & The Society of Phenomenology and the Human Sciences, Duquesne University.

Porto, A. (2024, April). *The picture theory of symbolic development in early childhood** [Conference presentation]. Midwinter Meeting of the Society for Theoretical and Philosophical Psychology, Duquesne University.

Porto, A., Flynn, C., Dall'Aglio, J. (2024, April). *Drawing connections: Ideas and applications of expressive activity in the clinic* [Conference Presentation]. Midwinter Meeting of the Society for Theoretical and Philosophical Psychology, Duquesne University.

Porto, A. (2024, April). *The picture theory of symbolic development in early childhood** [Conference presentation]. Conference of Multimodality in Early Interactions for ECRs, University of Warwick.

Porto, A. (2022, October). *Reified childhood: Social reification during child development** [Conference presentation]. Emory Symposium for Psychoanalysis & Politics, Emory University.

Porto, A., Anderson, L., Zebracki, K., Deane, K., Vogel, L. (2018, June). *Barriers in accessing adult healthcare for transitioning youth with spinal cord injury** [Conference presentation]. 57th Annual Scientific Meeting of the International Spinal Cord Society.

Porto, A., Anderson, L., Zebracki, K., Deane, K., Vogel, L. (2018, May). *Barriers in accessing adult healthcare for transitioning youth with spinal cord injury** [Conference presentation]. 72nd Annual Meeting of the American Academy for Cerebral Palsy and Developmental Medicine.

Porto, A. (2015, April). *Phenomenological responses to architectural environments* [Conference presentation]. Eighth Annual Meeting of the Society for Humanistic Psychology (APA Division 32).

AWARDS, FUNDING & HONORS

Award for Excellence in Teaching Duquesne University (Dept. Psychology) Honorarium: \$250.00	2025–2026
Pre-Doctoral Fellowship Award Universität Leipzig Research funding: 15,600.00€	2021–2022
Full Scholarship Capra Course: The Systems View of Life (Schumacher College & Fritjof Capra)	2019–2020

SOCIETY MEMBERSHIP & ADDITIONAL SCIENTIFIC ACTIVITY

Academic Consultant <i>Laboratory for Cybernetics</i> Carnegie Mellon University, School of Architecture	2025–present
Organizing Member #NewMacy In-Person Meetings Carnegie Mellon University, School of Architecture <i>jointly organized with Paul Pangaro</i>	2024–2025
Visiting Student University of Pittsburgh (Dept. Philosophy) <i>Sellars as a Metaphysician: Norms and Nature, Appearance and Reality</i> Invited by Robert Brandom, Ph.D.	Fall 2023
Full Member	Young Network for Wittgensteinian Philosophy
Student Member	Cognitive Science Society
Full Member	American Society for Cybernetics
Reviewer	Journal of Humanistic Psychology
Reviewer	Topics in Spinal Cord Injury Rehabilitation

COMPETENCIES & LANGUAGES

- **Research Methods:** Experimental Design, Mixed-Methods Research, Computational Modeling, Data Analysis (Bayesian and Frequentist), Philosophical Analysis, Literature Review, Manuscript Development
- **Programming:** R, Python (PyGaze, PsychoPy, Pygame), jsPsych, SPSS, Pure Data, OpenPose, GitHub, OpenMusic, Jupyter Notebooks, ChuckK, lab.js, HTML, Qualtrics, L^AT_EX
- **Psychological Assessment:** MMPI-2, PAI, CCAPS, BDI/BDI-Y, BAI/BAI-Y, HAM-A, GAD-7, WISC-V, NEO PI-R/FFI, TAT SCORS-G System, Rorschach R-PAS, Sentence Completion, Bender-Gestalt, OQ-45
- **Therapeutic Modalities:** Phenomenological Psychotherapy, Intensive Short-Term Dynamic Psychotherapy, MBCT/CBT, DBT, Systemic Therapy
- **Supervision & Training:** Undergraduate Research Mentorship, Master's Student Supervision, Peer Consultation, Group Peer Consultation
- **Languages:** English (Native Language), German (CEFR C1), French (CEFR A2–B1)

COLLABORATIVE RELATIONSHIPS

Alexander Kranjec

Christine Cuskley

Marcus Perlman

Luz Christopher Seiberth

Julio Santiago

Robert Hepach

Alexander Basalyga

Nikolai Huckle

Joost Pietschmann

Paul Pangaro

Liz Pienkos

Shantanu Tilak

REFERENCES

Dr. Alexander Kranjec

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email: kranjeca@duq.edu

Dr. Marcus Perlman

Linguistics and Communication, University of Birmingham
email: m.perlman@bham.ac.uk

Dr. Luz Christopher Seiberth

Department of Philosophy, Universität Potsdam
email: luz.christopher.seiberth@uni-potsdam.de

Prof. Dr. Kristina Musholt

Department of Philosophy (Chair of Cognitive Anthropology), Leipzig University
email: kristina.musholt@uni-leipzig.de

Prof. Dr. Patricia Kanngießer

School of Psychology, University of Plymouth
email: patricia.kanngiesser@plymouth.ac.uk

Prof. Dr. Robert Hepach

Oxford Department of Experimental Psychology, University of Oxford
email: robert.hepach@psy.ox.ac.uk